PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Nissan Patrol 160 / MQ

1980–1989 · 160 · 161 · MQ · MK

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust: where to look**
  NissanPatrol.com.au members list roof gutters, the plenum under the windscreen (a leak there rots the floor and the low-set body mounts), front floor pans, the radiator support, the inner guard under the battery tray, door bottoms, rear lower quarter panels and the top of the rear wheel arch. Chassis-to-body mount points are where the worst rust lives.

- [ ] **Turbo or not?**
  A turbo SD33T has 'Turbo' on the rocker cover and a turbocharger on the exhaust side. Owners warn that some non-turbo engines wear turbo rocker covers, so look for the turbo itself.

- [ ] **24 or 12 volts**
  MQ SD33 diesels ran 24-volt electrics with twin batteries; MKs are 12-volt. The engine number won't tell you. Owners say the starter, injection-pump solenoid and glow plugs are the voltage-sensitive parts, so a half-converted truck can be a headache.

- [ ] **Which diff is under it**
  Rear axles were C200, H233 or H260 (utes) depending on market and model. The ratio is stamped on a tin plate at the front of the driver's-side inner guard (for example HG43 means H233, 4.3:1). Members warn that MQ H233 parts and lockers aren't interchangeable with the later H233B in GQs and GUs.

- [ ] **Can you undo the plugs and grease it?**
  One member's advice: make sure you can crack the drain and fill plugs on both diffs, the gearbox and the transfer case, and buy a good grease gun. The leaf-sprung Patrol has far more grease nipples than a coil-sprung GQ, including greasable shackles.

- [ ] **Suspension history**
  Original springs are 40 years old and usually sagged. Ask what's been replaced. Owners say a rebuild with new leaves, U-bolts, shocks and shackles quickly costs more than an MQ is worth, and shackle extensions can invert.

- [ ] **Overheating and the head gasket**
  An SD33T that keeps losing coolant isn't automatically a head-gasket job. Forum diagnosis starts with the radiator, cap, hoses, thermostat and fan clutch. If the head does come off, the SD33T needs its own head gasket; the non-turbo SD33 gasket doesn't fit it correctly.

- [ ] **Import paperwork (US)**
  Nissan never sold the 160 Patrol new in the US. US examples on Bring a Trailer came from Japan (Safari fire trucks), South Africa and Colombia. Check the title, the import documents and that the chassis number matches.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **MQ vs MK**
  MQ: round headlights, two-spoke wheel, flat radio pod, four holes in the stone tray. MK: rectangular headlights, three-spoke wheel, tapered pod with clock, six slots in the stone tray, rear indicators in the bumper, extra inner-guard bracing (NissanPatrol.com.au).

- [ ] **VIN and model code**
  A Japanese-built truck's VIN carries the model code; one owner's reads JN10KR160U0... Parts sellers list codes such as KR160 (SD33), KM160/WMG160 (L28), VG160 (P40) and URG/VRG/WRG160 (SD33 and SD33T). Spanish-built trucks may show 260.

- [ ] **Turbo or not**
  An SD33T has a turbocharger on the exhaust side and 'Turbo' on the rocker cover, but owners warn that turbo covers turn up on non-turbo engines.

- [ ] **Diff plate**
  A tin plate at the front of the driver's-side inner guard gives the rear axle code and ratio, e.g. HG43 for an H233 at 4.3:1. Crown wheels are also stamped with tooth counts, such as 37:8 (4.625).

- [ ] **24 vs 12 volts**
  MQ SD33 diesels are 24-volt, with batteries on both sides of the engine bay; MKs are 12-volt with one battery on the passenger side. The engine number won't tell you.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/nissan-patrol/160-mq/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks